Pol

December 15, 1949

Dear Arthur:

I have your letter of December 14th. I am delighted that your plans for Washington are materializing, and that you will be going down next week. I imagine you will want a complete rest for a bit after you arrive, but I should like to see you as soon after that as is convenient.

As regards your question concerning the World Court, as the matter now stands a Security Council request for an advisory opinion is treated as subject to veto. However, the Interim Committee (Little Assembly" has the power to ask for an advisory opinion. This was given to it last winter in Paris primarily at my instigation and it is, therefore, possible in that way to get around the Soviet veto power in the Security Council. The idea was suggested to me by the Berlin situation where we might have wanted to get an advisory opinion as to our right of access. But of course I had in mind other comparable situations might develop.

Best wishes to Hazel and looking forward eagerly to seeing you both soon, and I hope before Christmas, I am

Faithfully yours,

The Honorable Arthur H. Vandenberg,
316 Morris Avenue, S.E.,
Grand Rapids, Michigan.